Tarik Skubal

LAD · LHP · Starter · Age 29 · 2,357 pitches · 26 G

Pitcher evaluation
2026 regular season
Data through **2026-09-27**
MLBAM 669373

IP	ERA	FIP	XFIP	XERA	K%	BB%	K-BB%	CSW%	WHIFF%	CHASE%	FB VELO
158.2	2.72	2.51	2.70	2.94	30.0%	4.4%	25.6%	30.7%	29.4%	36.6%	96.8

BOTTOM LINE

1. **Best pitch: sinker (65 Stuff / 65 Results):** 16.4% whiff, .309 xwOBA, 17% usage; 10th-most velo of 110 LHP sinkers (96.7 mph).
2. **Elite run prevention by xERA:** 2.72 ERA, 2.94 xERA (90th pct), 2.51 FIP, 25.6% K-BB.
3. **Plus-plus command (70):** 4.4% BB (99th pct), 39% of pitches on the edge, 69% first-pitch strikes.
4. **Plus bat-missing (65):** 30.0% K, 29.4% whiff/swing (91st pct), 30.7% CSW.
5. **Underused sinker (65 Results):** .309 xwOBA, 16% whiff, RV/100 +0.9 on only 17% usage (42% vs LHH / 11% vs RHH).

20–80 GRADES

vs 424 pitchers ≥600 pitches

Stuff	60	+0.24 RV/100
Command	70	BB 4.4%
Bat-missing	65	Whiff 29%
Contact mgmt	55	xwOBAcon .350
Durability	65	IP/GS 6.1

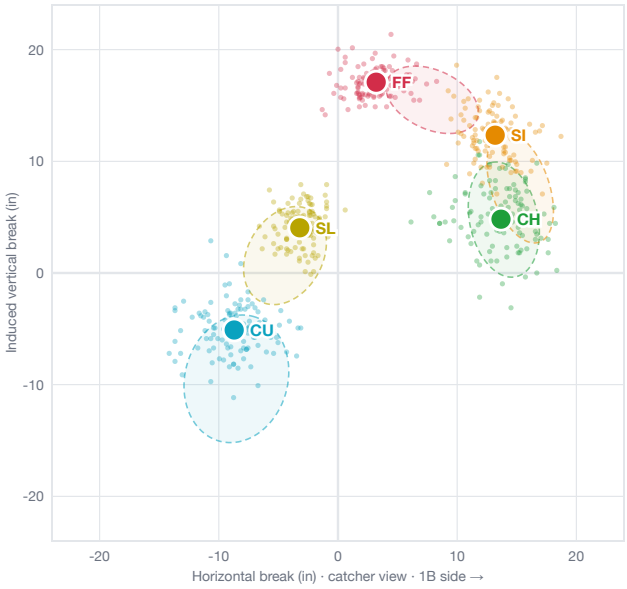
ARSENAL Arsenal — sinker is the best pitch by shape (65 Stuff, plus)

Velo mph · spin rpm · IVB/HB inches, catcher view (HB + = toward 1B) · Ext ft · Whiff per swing · Chase = swing % outside zone · xwOBA per PA ended · RV/100 = count-neutral run value per 100 pitches, + = good for pitcher · cells tinted by percentile within pitch type & hand · grey rows: n < 100

	USAGE				USAGE BY COUNT				SHAPE					RESULTS					GRADES (20–80)		
PITCH	N	ALL	VL	VR	0-0	AHD	BHD	2K	VELO	SPIN	IVB	HB	EXT	WHIFF	CHASE	CSW	XWOBA	RV/100	STUFF	RES	CMD
Four-seam FF	896	**38%**	24%	42%	38%	39%	39%	37%	96.8	2332	17.1	3.2	6.4	23%	36%	27%	.276	+1.3	60	60	55
Changeup CH	603	**26%**	19%	27%	14%	32%	22%	36%	87.7	1847	4.8	13.7	6.3	46%	46%	33%	.231	+1.0	60	70	50
Sinker SI	412	**17%**	42%	11%	21%	14%	20%	13%	96.7	2193	12.3	13.2	6.4	16%	25%	30%	.309	+0.9	65	65	60
Slider SL	327	**14%**	8%	16%	19%	9%	19%	9%	89.7	2203	4.0	-3.2	6.4	25%	29%	36%	.275	+1.5	60	50	60
Curveball CU	118	**5%**	7%	4%	7%	7%	1%	5%	80.4	2547	-5.1	-8.7	6.4	39%	31%	35%	.225	-0.4	45	60	35

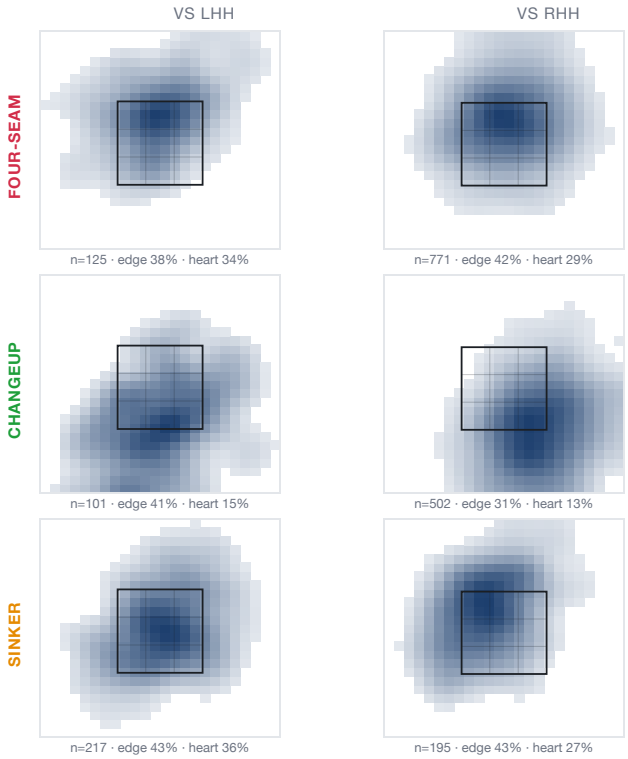
SHAPE Movement — four-seam carries 1.6 in more IVB than the average LHP four-seam

Dots = individual pitches (≤110 per type); large markers = his averages; dashed ellipses = league 1-SD shape for the same pitch type from LHPs. Inches, catcher view.



LOCATION Location — 61% of his four-seams finish in the upper third or above

Smoothed density of pitch locations (catcher view; box = average rule-book zone, thirds marked). Darker = more frequent (frequency, not quality) · edge = within ±3 in of the zone border.



COUNTS Count strategy — most predictable in 1-0 vs LHH (67% sinker)

Throws most = his most-used pitch in each count (tint: red = mixed, blue = ≥70% one pitch, i.e. predictable). Model pick = lowest expected xwOBA from the situational model vs a league-average hitter (◆ = differs). Mix gap = his actual mix's model xwOBA minus the model pick's, in points (.001); blue = larger opportunity.

VS LHH	0-0	1-0	2-0	3-0	0-1	1-1	2-1	3-1	0-2	1-2	2-2	3-2
Throws most	SI 63% n=145	SI 67% n=33	SI 56% n=9	SI 100% n=2	SI 36% n=92	SI 46% n=46	SI 50% n=14	FF 67% n=3	FF 42% n=53	FF 37% n=68	CH 39% n=41	SI 71% n=14
Model pick	SL ◆	SL ◆	SL ◆	SL ◆	FF ◆	FF ◆	SL ◆	SL ◆	FF	FF	SL ◆	FF ◆
Mix gap (pts)	9	9	14	8	11	6	7	17	10	9	8	10
VS RHH	**0-0**	**1-0**	**2-0**	**3-0**	**0-1**	**1-1**	**2-1**	**3-1**	**0-2**	**1-2**	**2-2**	**3-2**
Throws most	FF 46% n=475	FF 40% n=160	FF 39% n=46	FF 88% n=16	FF 46% n=270	FF 39% n=195	FF 43% n=68	FF 41% n=22	FF 42% n=143	CH 39% n=212	FF 37% n=166	FF 40% n=63
Model pick	SL ◆	SL ◆	SL ◆	CU ◆	FF	FF	SL ◆	SL ◆	FF	FF ◆	SL ◆	CU ◆
Mix gap (pts)	6	7	9	15	9	5	8	20	11	8	8	4

MOST PREDICTABLE

1-0 vs LHH · **67% SI** n=33
0-0 vs LHH · **63% SI** n=145
0-0 vs RHH · **46% FF** n=475

LARGEST MODEL GAPS

1-2 vs RHH · CH 39% → **FF** .284→.267
0-0 vs LHH · SI 63% → **SL** .255→.244
0-1 vs LHH · SI 36% → **FF** .279→.267

SEQUENCE Sequencing — FF/CU is the best tunnel pair (5.0× separation after the decision point)

Share (%) of next pitch within the same PA, by previous pitch. Tunnel = mean trajectories 23.8 ft from the plate vs at the plate.

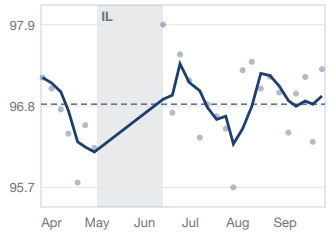
AFTER ↓ / NEXT →	FF	CH	SI	SL	CU
FF n=665	34	30	14	15	6
CH n=425	44	31	15	8	1
SI n=310	34	27	22	10	6
SL n=248	44	27	18	11	0
CU n=87	36	39	11	9	5

Best tunnel: **FF/CU** — 2.8 in apart at the decision point, 14.2 in apart at the plate (5.0× late separation; release 2.1 in apart)
Slider after FF: **32% whiff** vs 25% overall (50 swings)
Sinker after FF: **21% whiff** vs 16% overall (39 swings)

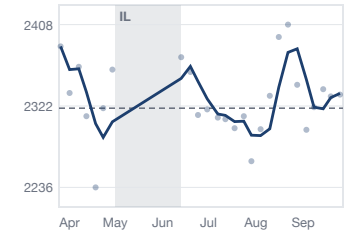
TRENDS Trends — stable through the season

Per game (dots), 3-game rolling mean (line), dashed = baseline before last 5 games; ⚑ shaded = flagged window (≥1 mph, 75 rpm or 0.2 ft). Grey = IL: May 1–Jun 13 (Loose bodies in left elbow).

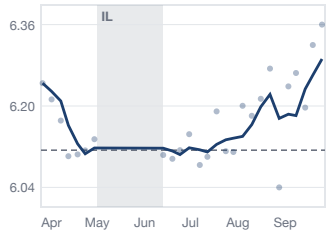
Primary FB velo (mph)



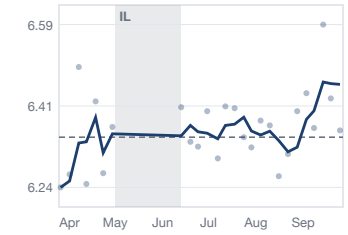
Primary FB spin (rpm)



Release height (ft)



Extension (ft)



SPLITS Splits — even platoon profile (17-pt xwOBA gap)

Statcast PAs, regular season. xwOBA tint vs league .315 (red = better for him). Times through order use the batter's PA count vs this pitcher in the game. Velo hold: primary FB +0.1 mph on pitches 76+ vs 1–25. Grey rows: < 60 PA.

SPLIT	PA	WOBA	XWOBA	K%	BB%	HR	WHIFF	CHASE
vs LHH	144	.306	.253	34.0%	2.8%	4	30%	37%
vs RHH	470	.265	.270	29.1%	4.9%	10	29%	36%
1st time	231	.250	.265	32.9%	3.0%	7	32%	40%
2nd time	232	.276	.273	30.2%	3.4%	5	29%	36%
3rd+ time	151	.309	.257	26.5%	7.9%	2	26%	33%

COMPS Comps — closest arsenal profile: Bradgley Rodriguez

Nearest neighbors among qualified pitchers on pitch mix, primary-FB velo/IVB/HB, arm angle, breaking-ball shape and separation, whiff% and zone% (standardized, weighted). Chip = comp's Stuff grade.

Bradgley Rodriguez SD 65 — 59% similar
RHP RP · FB 98.3 mph, 17" IVB · CH 42% / FF 26% / SI 25%

Kyle Hurt LAD 50 — 58% similar
RHP RP · FB 96.6 mph, 16" IVB · FF 55% / CH 35% / SL 9%

Dylan Cease TOR 65 — 56% similar
RHP SP · FB 96.8 mph, 18" IVB · FF 37% / SL 30% / CH 11% / CU 10%

DEVELOP Development notes — usage direction from the arsenal optimizer

Constrained optimizer on the outcome model (each pitch ±15 pts, 3–55% bounds). Expected gains are small and model-dependent: hypotheses for the pitching staff, not prescriptions.

vs LHH: FF 24→39%, SI 42→27%, CH 19→28% (model xwOBA -2 pts, n=520)
vs RHH: FF 42→27%, SL 16→31%, CH 27→35% (model xwOBA -1 pts, n=1836)
Since IL return (Jun 13): FB 96.9 mph vs 96.5 before (+0.3, 19 games).

Grades. each scale is a z-score composite converted to a percentile within the qualified pool, then 50 + 10·Φ⁻¹(p), clipped 20–80 and shown to the nearest 5. Pitch grades are within the same pitch type and throwing hand (≥100 pitches). Stuff = a gradient-boosted model of expected, count-neutral run value from velo, movement, spin, extension, release, arm angle and separation from the primary fastball (no location or results; held-out pitch-type correlation r=0.37). Results = whiff%, CSW%, xwOBA. Command = edge%, waste%, heart% (pitch) and BB%, edge, zone, first-strike (overall). Durability = IP/start, pitches/game, late-game velo hold (relievers: G, IP). **Models.** count plan = situational pitch-type model (2026, generic league-average hitter, medium leverage, 2nd time through); location/tunneling from Statcast trajectory fits at a 23.8 ft decision point; usage suggestion = constrained arsenal optimizer (±15 pts/pitch). Model gaps are small effects — treat as direction. **Caveats.** single season, regular season only; small-sample cells greyed; xwOBA ignores park and defense; IL dates from MLB transactions (retroactive dates honored).